



AI as Your Sales Partner

MODULE 1

A practical course for IQVIA sales reps, sales managers, customer service personnel, and new IQVIA personnel — designed to improve job performance in a measurable, real-world way.

The Promise

Use AI as a practical work partner to sharpen your skills and elevate team performance.

The Outcome

Improve sales team results and revenue-producing performance in ways you can measure.

The Method

Learn by doing — with AI as your coach, role-play partner, and feedback engine.

Why This Skill Matters Now

Inconsistent sales teams cost organizations more than most leaders realize. When reps practice differently, prepare unevenly, and receive feedback too late — revenue suffers and trust erodes.

67%

Reps Miss Quota

Without consistent coaching and structured practice, most reps underperform their potential.

3x

Faster Improvement

Teams that practice with structured feedback improve three times faster than those who don't.

40%

Time Lost

Sales managers spend nearly 40% of their time on reactive coaching instead of proactive development.



For IQVIA sales reps, managers, customer service personnel, and new hires — inconsistent preparation is the single biggest barrier to hitting business goals. Better practice, powered by AI, changes that equation.



What Changes When AI Becomes a Working Partner

AI doesn't replace your judgment — it amplifies it. When positioned correctly, AI becomes a versatile partner that supports every stage of your sales work.



Coach

Provides structured feedback on your approach, language, and strategy in real time.



Teammate

Thinks through problems alongside you, offering alternative perspectives and ideas.



Role-Play Partner

Simulates realistic customer conversations, objections, and constraints for safe practice.



Research Assistant

Quickly surfaces relevant information, competitive context, and customer insights.



Planning Partner

Helps structure call plans, account strategies, and meeting agendas efficiently.



Feedback Partner

Reviews your outputs and suggests specific, actionable improvements before you act.

The Core Workflow

Every strong AI-assisted sales interaction follows a simple, repeatable five-step workflow. Master this loop and you can apply it to any sales or revenue-producing situation.



Prepare

Research context, set goals, and build your AI prompt before the work begins.



Act

Execute the conversation, pitch, or task with AI support available in real time.



Review

Debrief with AI — what worked, what didn't, and what the data suggests.



Improve

Refine your approach based on feedback before the next interaction.



Transfer

Apply the improved approach directly to your real-world sales work.

 This workflow is the backbone of every module in this course. Return to it whenever you feel stuck or unsure how to use AI effectively in a new situation.

Strong vs. Weak: Spot the Difference

Review the two examples below. Identify the specific behaviors that make the stronger version more effective — and consider what the weaker version is missing.

⚠️ Weak Example

A sales rep opens a call with a generic introduction, references no customer-specific context, and responds to an objection with a feature list. When the customer hesitates, the rep repeats the same points louder and faster.

- No preparation or personalization
- Objection handled with repetition, not insight
- No clear next step proposed
- Customer feels unheard and disengaged

✓ Strong Example

A sales rep opens with a specific reference to the customer's recent business challenge, asks a clarifying question, and responds to an objection by acknowledging the concern and reframing the value. A clear next step is proposed and confirmed.

- Personalized opening tied to customer context
- Objection met with empathy and reframing
- Clear, confirmed next step
- Customer feels understood and respected



Discussion prompt: What three behaviors in the strong example could you apply in your next customer interaction this week?

Your First Practical AI Prompt

The quality of your AI interaction depends entirely on the quality of your prompt. Below is a proven starter prompt designed specifically for sales and revenue-producing teams. Copy it, customize it, and make it yours.

"Act as a practical coach for sales teams and revenue-producing teams. Ask me one question at a time, review my answer, and suggest a stronger next move."

Why "One Question at a Time"?

It forces focused thinking. When AI asks one question, you give a real answer — not a surface-level response. This mirrors how great coaches actually work.

Why "Review My Answer"?

You get immediate, specific feedback on what you said — not generic advice. This is the fastest path to improvement in any sales skill.

Why "Suggest a Stronger Next Move"?

AI doesn't just critique — it helps you build forward. Every session ends with a concrete action, not just a score.

- ✔ Try this prompt right now. Open your AI tool, paste the prompt, and answer the first question it asks. Notice how different the conversation feels compared to a generic search.

Real-World Scenario

This scenario is designed to mirror the pressure, ambiguity, and business stakes you face in actual IQVIA sales situations. There are no perfect answers — only better and worse approaches.

 **The Scenario:** You have 20 minutes before a call with a key account manager who has expressed concern about your product's ROI compared to a competitor. You have incomplete data, a tight timeline, and a clear goal: keep the account and advance the relationship. How do you prepare — and how does AI help you do it faster and better?

01

Define the Business Goal

What is the single most important outcome you need from this conversation? Write it in one sentence before you open AI.

03

Build Your Opening and Objection Plan

Use AI to draft a strong opening statement and prepare for the two most likely objections you'll face.

02

Identify What You Know and Don't Know

List the facts you have, the gaps in your information, and the assumptions you're making. AI can help you fill gaps quickly.

04

Set Your Next Step in Advance

Decide what a successful outcome looks like and what you'll ask for at the end of the call — before it starts.

Guided Practice: Use AI, Get Feedback, Revise

Learning happens in the revision, not the first attempt. This three-part practice cycle is the engine of improvement in this course.



Step 1: Complete the Short Task

Write a 3-sentence opening for a sales call with a skeptical customer. Focus on relevance, clarity, and a clear value statement. Do this without AI first — use your own judgment.



Step 2: Use AI for Feedback

Paste your opening into AI with this prompt: *"Review this sales opening for clarity, relevance, and business value. Tell me what's strong and what to improve."*
Read the feedback carefully.



Step 3: Revise Your Approach

Rewrite your opening using the AI feedback. Compare version one and version two side by side. What changed? What did you learn about your own defaults and blind spots?

📌 The goal is not a perfect output — it's a better habit. Repeat this cycle with any sales task and your baseline will rise every week.

Role-Play Round: AI as Your Counterpart

The best way to prepare for difficult conversations is to have them — safely, repeatedly, and with honest feedback. AI makes this possible anytime, anywhere.

Role-Play Prompt: *"Act as a skeptical hospital procurement manager who is evaluating two competing vendors. You have budget pressure, a tight timeline, and a preference for the competitor. Respond to my sales pitch with realistic objections and constraints. Do not make it easy for me."*

What to Practice

- Handling price and ROI objections
- Responding to competitor comparisons
- Managing time pressure in a conversation
- Asking for the next step confidently

How to Debrief

- Ask AI: "What did I do well in that exchange?"
- Ask AI: "Where did I lose momentum or credibility?"
- Ask AI: "What would a top performer have said differently?"
- Write down one thing to change in the next round.

Repeat Until It Feels Natural

- Run the role-play at least three times
- Change one variable each round (customer type, objection, time pressure)
- Track your improvement across rounds
- Share your best version with your manager or peer

Debrief and Coaching: The Five-Point Rubric

After every practice session, role-play, or real interaction, use this rubric to evaluate your performance and identify your next improvement priority. Honest self-assessment is the foundation of growth.



Clarity

Was your message easy to understand? Could the customer repeat your key point back to you?



Relevance

Did your message connect directly to the customer's specific situation, challenge, or goal?



Business Value

Did you articulate a clear, credible business outcome — not just a product feature?



Human Judgment

Did you apply your own experience and empathy — not just AI output — to the situation?



Next Action

Did you leave the interaction with a clear, agreed-upon next step that advances the relationship?

 Use this rubric with AI: paste your sales output and ask AI to score each dimension from 1–5 with specific evidence. Then ask: "What would a 5 look like for the lowest-scoring dimension?"

Build Your AI Teammate

An AI teammate is a set of written instructions that tells AI exactly how to support you — before, during, and after your sales work. Think of it as programming your own personal coach.

Why Write Instructions?

Generic AI gives generic results. When you write specific instructions, AI behaves like a teammate who knows your role, your customers, and your goals.

Your instructions should reflect:

- Your specific sales role and territory
- Your most common customer types
- Your biggest skill gaps and development goals
- The tone and style that fits your brand

Your AI Teammate Template

Before the work: "Help me prepare for [situation] by asking me about my goal, my customer context, and my biggest concern."

During the work: "Act as [customer type]. Respond realistically and push back on weak points in my approach."

After the work: "Review what I did. Score me on clarity, relevance, business value, human judgment, and next action. Give me one specific thing to improve."

- ✓ Write your own version of these three instructions now. The more specific you are, the more useful your AI teammate becomes.

Your AI-Assisted Sales Checklist

This job aid is designed to be used in the real world — before, during, and after every significant sales interaction. Print it, save it, or keep it open on your device.

Before the Interaction

- ☐ Define your single most important goal for this interaction
- ☐ Identify what you know, what you don't know, and your key assumptions
- ☐ Use AI to prepare your opening statement and anticipate objections
- ☐ Set your desired next step before the conversation begins
- ☐ Review any relevant customer context or recent account activity

During the Interaction

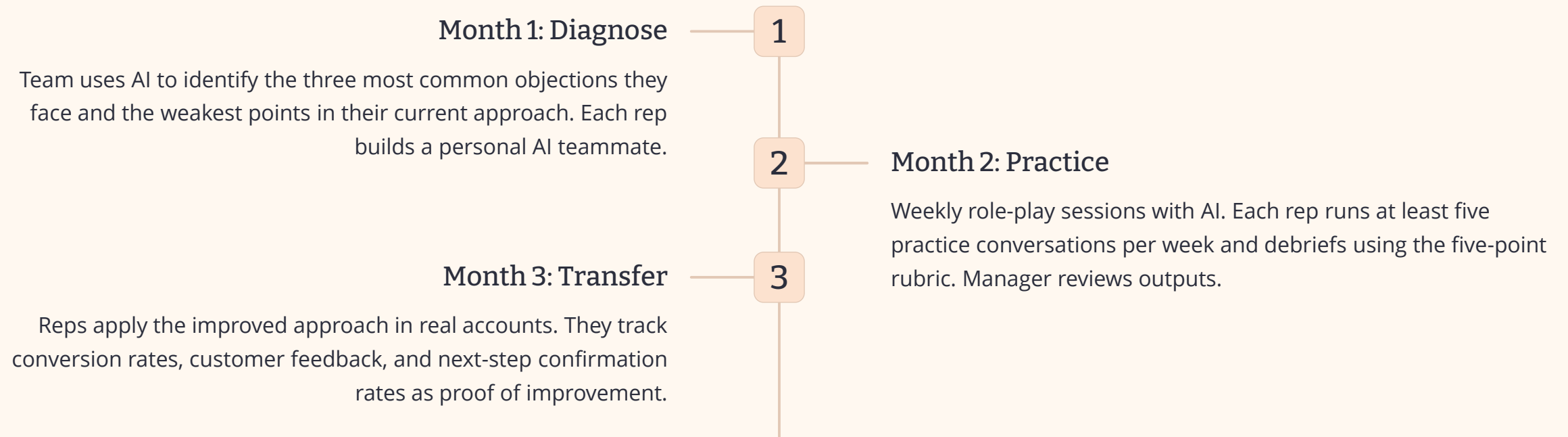
- ☐ Open with a personalized, customer-specific reference
- ☐ Ask at least one clarifying question before presenting solutions
- ☐ Respond to objections with empathy before reframing
- ☐ Connect every point to a clear business outcome
- ☐ Confirm the next step explicitly before ending

After the Interaction

- ☐ Debrief with AI using the five-point rubric
- ☐ Write down one thing that worked and one thing to improve
- ☐ Update your AI teammate instructions based on what you learned
- ☐ Schedule your next practice session within 48 hours
- ☐ Share your improvement with your manager or a peer

Case Study: Quality, Trust, and Business Outcomes

A regional IQVIA sales team is under pressure to improve performance metrics while maintaining the trust of long-standing healthcare accounts. They have three months, a new AI tool, and a skeptical manager who wants proof before scaling.



✅ **Result:** The team improved next-step confirmation rates by 28%, reduced objection-handling time by 40%, and maintained a 95% customer satisfaction score — while the manager became the program's biggest advocate.

Group Activity: Choose the Strongest Approach

In small groups, review three AI-assisted sales approaches to the same customer situation. Your task: choose the strongest option and build a clear, evidence-based case for why it works best.

Approach A: Feature-Led

The rep uses AI to generate a comprehensive list of product features and presents them in order of technical sophistication. The AI prompt was: "List all the benefits of our product."

Evaluate: Does this approach connect to the customer's business goal? Is the AI being used strategically or as a shortcut?

Approach B: Objection-Ready

The rep uses AI to anticipate the customer's top three objections, prepares a specific response to each, and opens the call by acknowledging the customer's known concern directly.

Evaluate: How does preparation change the quality of the conversation? What does this approach signal to the customer?

Approach C: Outcome-Anchored

The rep uses AI to research the customer's recent business challenges, builds an opening tied to a specific outcome the customer cares about, and uses AI to debrief after the call.

Evaluate: How does this approach use AI across the full workflow — not just for preparation? What makes it sustainable?

 Group debrief question: Which approach would your best customer respond to most positively — and why? What does that tell you about how you currently prepare?

Assessment Task: Show Your Work

This is your opportunity to demonstrate what you've learned — not just what you know. The assessment is designed to mirror a real sales situation and evaluate both your output and your process.

1

The Task

Choose a real or realistic sales situation from your current territory. Prepare for it using the full AI-assisted workflow: prepare, act, review, improve, and transfer.

2

What to Submit

Submit two things: (1) your final output — the opening, objection responses, and next step you would use in the real interaction, and (2) the AI prompts you used to build and refine it.

3

How It Will Be Evaluated

Your submission will be reviewed against the five-point rubric: clarity, relevance, business value, human judgment, and next action. Both the output and the prompts matter.

4

The Standard

A passing submission demonstrates that you used AI as a thinking partner — not a shortcut. Your human judgment should be visible in every part of the output.

 **Tip:** The quality of your AI prompts is as important as the quality of your final output. Reviewers will look for evidence that you iterated, refined, and applied your own judgment throughout the process.

Common Mistakes to Avoid

Most AI-assisted sales work fails not because the tool is wrong — but because the user makes predictable, avoidable mistakes. Learn to recognize these patterns before they cost you a deal.

→ Generic Prompts

"Help me with my sales call" produces generic output. Specific prompts — with customer context, your goal, and the constraints you're working within — produce useful output. Always add context before you ask.

→ Unsupported Facts

AI can generate plausible-sounding statistics and claims that are not accurate. Never use a fact, figure, or claim from AI without verifying it against a trusted source. Your credibility depends on it.

→ Tone Mismatch

AI defaults to a neutral, formal tone. Your customer relationship may require warmth, directness, or technical depth. Always review AI output for tone and adjust it to match your voice and your customer's expectations.

→ Weak Context

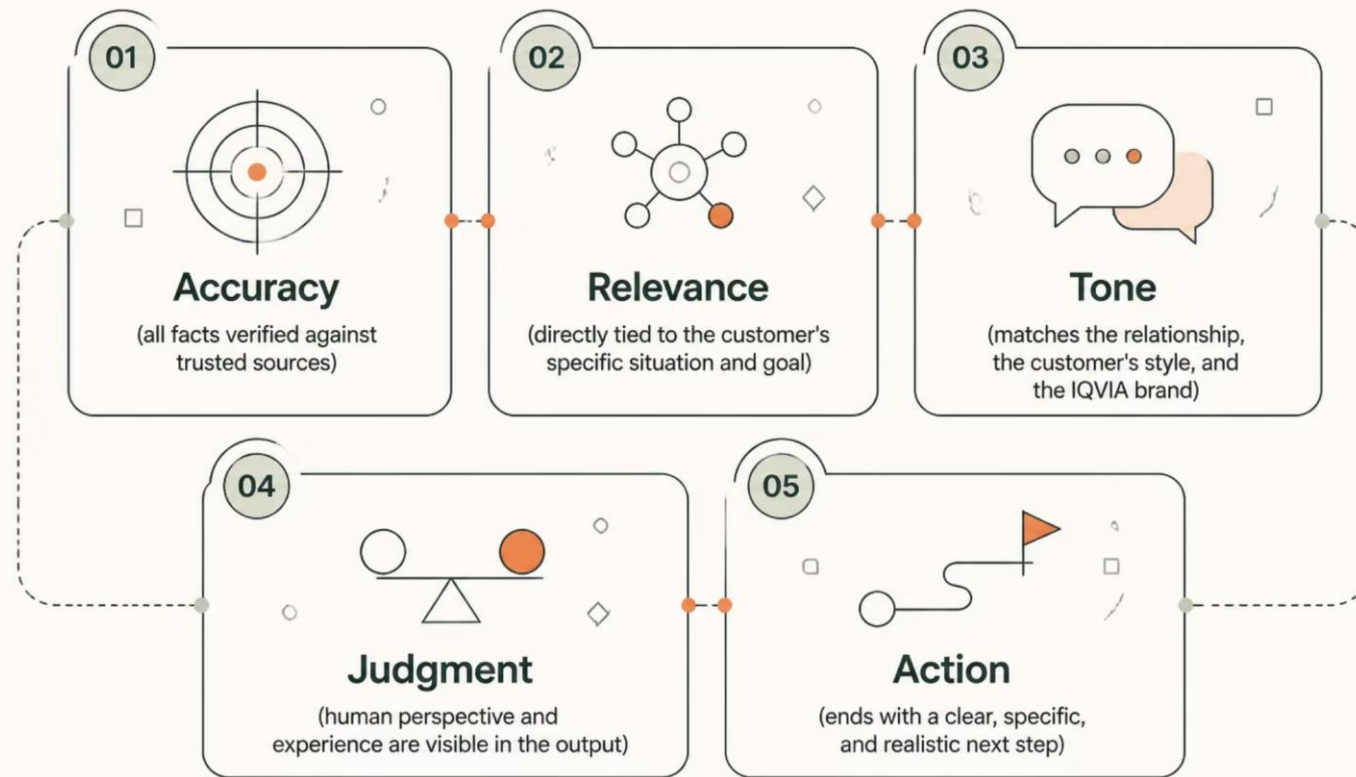
AI only knows what you tell it. If you don't share the customer's situation, your goal, and the constraints you're working with, AI will fill the gaps with assumptions — and those assumptions are often wrong.

→ Skipping Human Review

AI output is a first draft, not a final answer. Every piece of AI-generated content must be reviewed, edited, and approved by a human before it reaches a customer. This is non-negotiable.

Quality Standards: What Good Work Looks Like

Before any AI-assisted output reaches a customer, a manager, or a business decision, it must meet a clear quality standard. Use this framework to check every piece of work before you use it.



The Human Review Checklist

Before using any AI output: (1) Read it aloud — does it sound like you? (2) Check every fact against a source you trust. (3) Ask: would my best customer find this relevant and credible? (4) Confirm the next step is realistic and specific. (5) Edit anything that doesn't pass all four tests.

The IQVIA Standard

IQVIA's reputation is built on accuracy, trust, and expertise. Any output that reaches a customer — whether AI-assisted or not — must reflect those values. When in doubt, ask a colleague or manager to review before you send.

Transfer to Daily Work: Your First Real Task

Learning that stays in the classroom doesn't improve performance. The transfer step is where this course pays off — and it starts this week.

- ✔ **Your Assignment:** Choose one real task from your work this week where you will use the AI-assisted workflow. It should be something that matters — a customer call, a proposal, a difficult conversation, or a planning session.

01

Choose Your Task

Pick one specific, real task from your calendar this week. Write it down. Be specific: not "a sales call" but "my Thursday call with [account name] about [specific topic]."

03

Document What Happened

Write a brief note after the interaction: what you prepared, what AI helped with, what you changed based on feedback, and what the outcome was.

02

Apply the Full Workflow

Use the prepare-act-review-improve-transfer cycle. Don't skip steps. The debrief after the interaction is as important as the preparation before it.

04

Share One Insight

Tell one colleague, your manager, or your learning group one thing you learned from applying the workflow in a real situation. Teaching accelerates your own learning.

Your 30-Day Action Plan

Sustainable improvement requires a plan — not just good intentions. Use this structure to build a 30-day practice schedule that fits your real workload and produces measurable results.

Week 1: Establish the Habit

Use the AI-assisted workflow for at least three real tasks. Build your personal AI teammate instructions. Complete one role-play session and debrief using the rubric.

1

2

Week 2: Increase Complexity

Apply the workflow to a more challenging situation — a difficult account, a competitive deal, or a conversation you've been avoiding. Use AI to prepare more deeply than usual.

3

Week 3: Measure and Adjust

Review your outputs from weeks 1 and 2. What improved? What's still weak? Update your AI teammate instructions and your checklist based on what you've learned.

4

Week 4: Reflect and Share

Write a brief reflection: what changed in your performance, what you'll keep doing, and what you'll teach to a colleague. Share your best AI prompt with your team.

Success Measures

- Next-step confirmation rate per week
- Objection-handling confidence (self-rated 1–10)
- Number of AI-assisted practice sessions completed
- Manager or peer feedback score on one real output

Follow-Up Reflection Prompts

- What is one habit I built that I didn't have 30 days ago?
- What is the most useful AI prompt I discovered?
- Where do I still rely on instinct when I should use a process?
- What would I tell a new colleague about using AI in sales?

Final Toolkit Review

You've built something real in this course — not just knowledge, but a set of practical tools you can use every day. Take a moment to review what you've created and commit to using it.



Your AI Prompts

Review the prompts you've written and refined throughout this course. Identify your top three — the ones that produced the most useful output — and save them somewhere you'll actually use them.



Your Checklist

Your before-during-after job aid is ready to use in the real world. Customize it one more time based on what you learned in the 30-day plan. Make it yours.



Your Role-Play Partner

Your AI role-play setup — with specific customer types, realistic objections, and debrief prompts — is a practice tool you can use before any important conversation for the rest of your career.



Your Improvement Plan

Your 30-day plan, success measures, and reflection prompts form a repeatable improvement cycle. Run it again next month — and the month after. Growth compounds.

"The reps who improve fastest are not the ones with the most talent — they are the ones who practice most deliberately, reflect most honestly, and use every available tool to get better. You now have the tools. Use them."



Congratulations on completing the course. Your next step: open your AI tool, run your best prompt, and apply what you've learned to a real situation today.